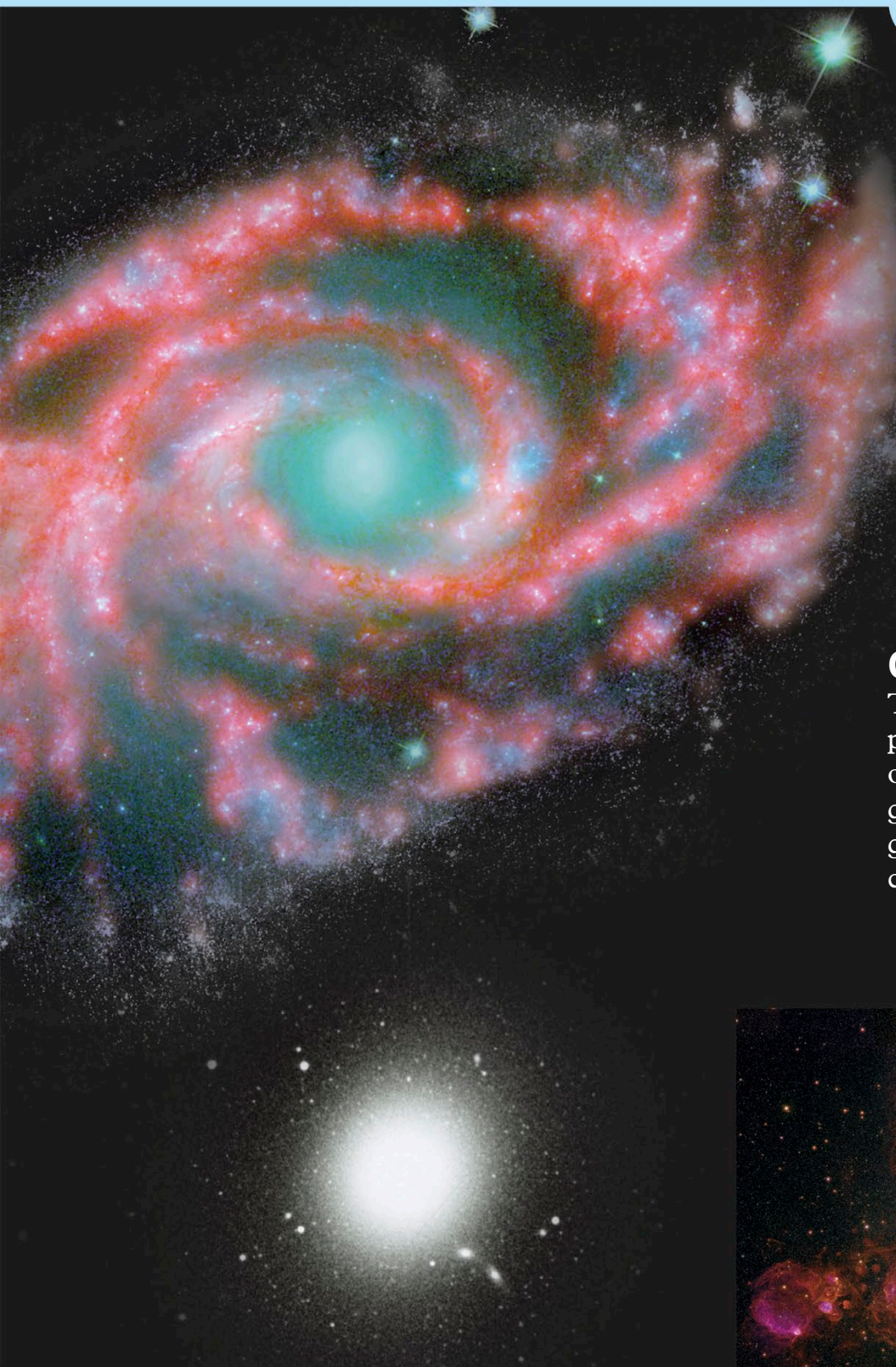




get mucky

Paint your own galaxy with white paint on black paper. Then splash drops of paint onto the paper to represent stars.

Collision course

Two galaxies may collide in a process that will take millions of years. The stars within the galaxy won't collide, but the gas and dust will – this collision can create new stars.



Elliptical galaxies

These galaxies are shaped like balls or eggs and are largely made up of old stars. They don't contain the gas clouds for the formation of new stars. An example of an elliptical galaxy is M87.

Irregular galaxies

Irregular galaxies of this kind have no shape. They contain lots of gas and dust, and many are therefore active nurseries for the formation of new stars. The UGC 8201 is an example of an irregular galaxy.